

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 609

By Vaughan

A RESOLUTION to honor the University of Memphis Tigers football team on an outstanding 2024 season.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing the University of Memphis (UM) Tigers, a football team that broke or equaled several school records in 2024, while racking up eleven wins, including a post-season bowl victory; and

WHEREAS, Memphis posted the first back-to-back double-digit win seasons in program history, and the Tigers' eleven wins in 2024 also marked just the second season in program history with eleven or more victories; and

WHEREAS, the Tigers compiled an extraordinary 21-5 record over the past two seasons, setting the UM record for most wins in a two-year span; and

WHEREAS, UM currently holds the longest active streak in the nation of scoring twenty or more points in forty consecutive games, dating back to a 33-28 win over Tulane on Nov. 27, 2021; and

WHEREAS, the Tigers' 20-12 victory over Florida State in 2024 marked their first win over a power conference opponent on the road since they defeated Kansas in 2015; and

WHEREAS, Memphis spent ten weeks either ranked or receiving votes in the AP Poll and fourteen weeks in the AFCA Coaches Poll during the 2024 season; and

WHEREAS, the Tigers finished the season ranked No. 23 in the AFCA Coaches Poll and No. 24 in the AP Poll, marking the first time since the 2019 season that UM was ranked in either poll at season's end; and

WHEREAS, seven Tiger gridiron greats earned First Team All-American Athletic Conference (AAC) honors and three received Third Team All-AAC nods; the seven first-team

honorees are the most for Memphis since joining the AAC in 2013, while the ten total honorees are the most for the Tigers since the 2019 season; and

WHEREAS, UM quarterback Seth Henigan eclipsed 14,000 career passing yards in the team's 42-37 win over West Virginia in the Scooter's Coffee Frisco Bowl and finished his collegiate career ranked 13th in NCAA history with 14,266 yards; and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan broke a longstanding UM record in the team's 33-28 win over Charlotte, when he threw a 24-yard touchdown pass to wide receiver Roc Taylor with 31 seconds left in the game to put the Tigers in the lead and seal the victory; his 91st career passing touchdown surpassed Brady White's total for the most touchdown passes ever by a Tiger; and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan threw his 104th career touchdown pass to Clayton Tune versus Houston to tie the AAC's career record; and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan secured his rightful place in Memphis football history as the program's all-time leader in passing yards, passing touchdowns, and completion percentage; all four of his collegiate season performances fall in the top ten single-season passing yard totals in Tiger history, ranking third (3,883 in 2023), sixth (3,571 in 2022), seventh (3,502 in 2024), and ninth (3,322 in 2021); and

WHEREAS, Seth Henigan was named the Offensive Most Valuable Player (MVP) of the 2024 Scooter's Coffee Frisco Bowl, while his teammate Chandler Martin was named Defensive MVP; their selections marked the second consecutive year that both Mr. Henigan and Mr. Martin were named bowl game MVPs, having received the same honors in the 2023 AutoZone Liberty Bowl; and

WHEREAS, after receiving an invitation to the Reese's Senior Bowl, Seth Henigan played with and against some of the best college football players in the land; he completed 12 of

14 passing attempts for 132 yards and a touchdown and was named MVP of the American Team; and

WHEREAS, Chandler Martin's 111 tackles ranked 29th in FBS, while his 16 tackles for loss ranked in the top fifteen nationally; and

WHEREAS, linebacker Chandler Martin and his teammate Mario Anderson, Jr., earned All-America Honorable Mention recognition from *Phil Steele* for their exemplary play during the season; and

WHEREAS, Mario Anderson, Jr., had one of the most productive seasons for a Tiger running back in program history, totaling 1,362 yards on the ground (sixth in Memphis history) while rushing for 18 touchdowns (tied for third); and

WHEREAS, Mario Anderson, Jr., finished the season ranked 8th in the country in total scrimmage yards (1,674) and total touchdowns (21); and

WHEREAS, Coach Ryan Silverfield and his staff molded the Tigers into ferocious predators whose hunger could only be satisfied by victory after victory; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the coaches and players of University of Memphis Tigers football team on an outstanding 2024 season during which they posted eleven victories for the second time in school history and won the Scooter's Coffee Frisco Bowl in post-season play with numerous All-AAC, All-American, and MVP honorees contributing.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.